

Sanctity Of Life

prc-sanctity-of-life

Christian Ethics · Sanctity of Life · doctrine · unanimous_lineages

AFFIRMS

score 1.000
confidence high

Statement under examination

Human life bears the image of God from conception to natural death and is to be protected; the intentional taking of innocent unborn human life is sin under the sixth commandment, not a morally neutral matter or a matter of Christian liberty.

In plain language

Several Hebrew and Greek word patterns bear on this proposition and they converge from different angles. Genesis 1:27 predicates the divine image (tselem) of the human (adam) as a category, with no qualifier for stage of life. Genesis 9:6 then says that whoever sheds the blood of a human, by a human shall his blood be shed, with the explicit reason: for in the image of God He made the human. The image of God is the stated ground of the prohibition on shedding human blood. Exodus 20:13 and Deuteronomy 5:17 both read lo tirtsach, do not murder, using the verb ratsach. Numbers 35:30 shows ratsach used for the unlawful killer while judicial execution uses a different verb, and Exodus 23:7 explicitly forbids killing the innocent person with naqi (innocent) and tsaddiq (righteous) named as the protected object. So ratsach denotes precisely the unlawful taking of an innocent human life. The womb passages use personal, individuated grammar. Psalm 139:13 to 16 has God forming, weaving, and acquiring the speaker in the womb, with the same first-person pronouns the psalmist uses of his present adult self, and God sees the golem, the unformed embryonic mass, which is a hapax legomenon, a word appearing only here in the Hebrew canon. Jeremiah 1:5 places know, form, and set apart before formation in the womb, all carrying a personal object suffix. Isaiah 49:1 and 49:5 repeat the same pattern of calling and forming from the womb. Hosea 9:11 names the triad birth, womb, and conception (herayon, used only three times in the canon), the closest single-clause witness to a from-conception lexical frame. Luke 1:41 to 44 calls the unborn John a brephos, the very same noun Luke uses of the newborn Jesus in the manger and of nursing infants, and attributes leaping and joy to him. Proverbs 6:17, Deuteronomy 19:10, and Psalm 106:38 all use the fixed locution shafak dam naqi, shed innocent blood, with Psalm 106:38 applying it explicitly to children sacrificed by their parents. One legal text, Exodus 21:22 to 25, is grammatically ambiguous and historically the strongest counter-anchor. The verb yatsa, come out, is the same root used elsewhere of normal birth (including Jeremiah 1:5 itself), and the noun ason, calamity, does not specify whose calamity is in view. So the text plausibly describes premature live birth with the life-for-life clause protecting the child too. Across all these threads the lexical pattern treats the unborn as a known, formed, image-bearing human and treats the unlawful killing of the innocent as categorically condemned. Legitimate distinctions the words themselves preserve are self-defense and judicial execution (a different verb), wartime killing under specific command (a different verb), and natural miscarriage (a different vocabulary, nefel or shakal). The case is strong because it does not depend on any one verse but on a recurring lexical structure across narrative, law, wisdom, prophecy, and gospel.

Word dictionary

Every Hebrew and Greek word this study leans on, in everyday terms. Shaded rows are the anchor words the verdict rests on.

Strong	Word	Sounds like	Plain meaning	Times in Bible
H0120	אָדָם	adam	man	554
H0611	אָסוֹן	ason	harm	

H0990	בֶּטֶן	beten	belly	72
H1254	בָּרָא	bara	to create	
H1564	גֵּלֶם	golem	embryo	1
H1818	דָּם	dam	blood	341
H2026	הָרַג	harag	to kill	157
H2032	הֶרְיוֹן	herayon	conception	3
H2962	טֶרֶם	terem	before	54
H3045	יָדַע	yada	to know	860
H3205	יָלַד	yalad	to beget	
H3318	יָצָא	yatsa	to come out	
H3335	יָצַר	yatsar	to form	63
H3789	כָּתַב	katav	to write	
H3808	לֹא	lo	not	4,825
H4191	מוֹת	muth	to die	807
H4578	מֶעָה	meeh	belly	
H5309	נֶפֶל	nephel	miscarriage	
H5315	נֶפֶשׁ	nephesh	soul	
H5355	נָקִי	naqi	innocent	43
H5526	סִכַּךְ	sukh	to fence	
H5650	עֶבֶד	eved	servant/slave	
H6064	עֲנֵשׁ	anash	to fine	
H6108	עֲצָם	otsem	strength	
H6395	פָּלָה	palah	be distinguished	
H6662	צַדִּיק	tsaddiq	righteous	
H6754	צֶלֶם	tselem	image	16
H6942	קָדַשׁ	qadash	to consecrate	172
H7069	קָנָה	qanah	to buy	83
H7121	קָרָא	qara	to call	
H7200	רָאָה	raah	to see	
H7358	רֶחֶם	rechem	womb	24
H7523	רָצַח	ratsach	to murder	46
H7551	רָקַם	raqam	to weave	9
H8210	שָׁפַךְ	shafak	to pour	117
H8441	תּוֹעֵבָה	toebah	abomination	117
G0020	ἀγαλλίασις	agalliasis	joy	
G1025	βρέφος	brephos	infant	8
G2836	κοιλία	koilia	belly/womb/stomach	23
G4640	σκιρτάω	skirtao	to leap	3

Verdict rationale

Variant-robust: True · Pan-canonical: True

Three lexical threads converge across the canon. First, Gen 1:27 predicates the divine tselem (H6754) of ha-adam as a category without developmental qualifier, and Gen 9:6 grounds the inviolability of human blood (dam ha-adam, H1818 + H0120) in that same image (ki betselem elohim asah eth ha-adam), with the verbal repetition shofek dam ha-adam ba-adam damo yishshafek (H8210 chiasm) making the image the explicit ratio of the prohibition. Second, the murder prohibition lo tirtsach (Exod 20:13 and Deut 5:17, H3808 plus H7523) uses ratsach, which Num 35:16-25 reserves for the unlawful killer over against the judicial executor (H4191 hiphil) and the wartime killer (H2026, harag), tightening its denotation to unlawful killing of an innocent human person, the very category Exod 23:7 and Prov 6:17 mark as forbidden under the rubric dam naqi (innocent blood). Third, the womb texts use continuous personal grammar across the prenatal stage: Ps 139:13-16 carries first-person verbs and suffixes through formation while the speaker is still golem (H1564, a true hapax), Jer 1:5 places yada (H3045), yatsar (H3335), and qadash (H6942) before formation in the beten (H0990) with second-person object suffixes, Isa 49:1,5 doubles the pattern with mibbeten and yatsar, Hos 9:11 even names the triad birth, womb, conception (herayon, H2032), and Luke 1:41,44 calls the unborn John brephos (G1025), the identical noun used of the newborn Jesus and of nursing infants in Luke 2:12, 2:16, 18:15, with sole occurrence-set spanning in-utero and post-utero usage. The Exod 21:22-25 crux is ambiguous in Hebrew but on a careful read of yatsa (the verb of normal birth in Jer 1:5) and ason (calamity, not specifying mother or child) the law is consistent with rather than against the broader pattern, so it does not lower confidence below high.

Scripture

Gen.1.27 · **for** · genre: narrative

Key terms. H6754 צֶלֶם, H1254 בָּרָא; H0120 אָדָם

Force. וַיִּבְרָא אֱלֹהִים אֶת הָאָדָם בְּצֶלְמוֹ בְּצֶלֶם אֱלֹהִים בָּרָא אֹתוֹ זָכָר וּנְקֵבָה בָּרָא אֹתָם. The threefold bara with the human as object, and the prepositional betselem (in the image), predicates the divine image of ha-adam as such without restriction by developmental stage, sex, or capacity. Gen 1:27 defines the category of the human as image-bearer, the value-grounding premise the sanctity claim depends on, and the same noun adam is the one whose blood Gen 9:6 protects.

Gen.9.6 · **for** · genre: narrative · figures: chiasm

Key terms. H8210 שָׁפַךְ, H1818 דָּם; H0120 אָדָם, H6754 צֶלֶם

Force. שָׁפַךְ דָּם הָאָדָם בָּאָדָם דָּמוֹ יִשְׁפָּךְ כִּי בְצֶלֶם אֱלֹהִים עָשָׂה אֶת הָאָדָם. The chiasmic shafak-dam-adam-adam-damo-yishshafek frame makes human blood inviolable, and the causal ki betselem elohim asah eth ha-adam supplies the explicit ratio: the image of God in adam is the ground of the prohibition. This single verse fuses the two anchor lemmas (tselem and dam) that the rest of the canon develops, and it predicates the image of the human category (not of any subset by age or stage).

Exod.20.13 · **for** · genre: law

Key terms. H3808 לֹא, H7523 רָצַח

Force. לֹא תִרְצַח. The negated imperfect of ratsach is an absolute prohibition. The Pentateuchal pattern (Num 35:16-25) reserves ratsach for the unlawful killer (the murderer and the manslayer, both designated rotseach), over against H4191 hiphil for judicial execution (Num 35:30, 35:31) and H2026 harag for general or wartime killing. So ratsach denotes precisely the unlawful taking of an innocent human person, which is the moral category the proposition addresses. Deut 5:17 repeats the same prohibition verbatim, confirming canon-stable usage.

Deut.5.17 · for · genre: law

Key terms. H3808 לא, H7523 רצח.

Force. לא תרצח. Verbatim repetition of Exod 20:13 in the Deuteronomic rehearsal of the Decalogue, establishing the ratsach prohibition as pan-Pentateuchal and not localized to a single context. Two independent witnesses to the same lexical choice.

Num.35.30 · for · genre: law

Key terms. H7523 רצח, H4191 מות, H5315 נפש.

Force. כל מכה נפש לפי עדים ירצח את הרצח. In a single verse ratsach is used both for the act being judicially punished and (with the participle rotseach) for the agent of unlawful killing, while the judicial putting-to-death uses H4191 hiphil. The lexical contrast between ratsach (unlawful killing) and muth-hiphil (judicial execution) is grammatically explicit here, foreclosing the reading that Exod 20:13 forbids all killing.

Exod.23.7 · for · genre: law

Key terms. H2026 הרג, H5355 נקי, H6662 צדיק.

Force. ונקי וצדיק אל תהרג. The jussive of harag governs the explicit object naqi (innocent) plus tsaddiq (righteous), categorically forbidding the killing of the innocent person. This generalizes the ratsach prohibition to the broader semantic field and explicitly names innocence as the protected category, the same category the womb texts establish for the unborn.

Ps.139.13 · for · genre: wisdom · figures: metaphor

Key terms. H7069 קנה, H5526 סכך, H0990 בטן.

Force. אתה קנית כליתי תסכני בבטן אמי. God is subject of qanah (acquire, form) and sakak (weave, cover) acting on the first-person speaker bābeten (in the womb). The prenatal subject is referred to by the same personal pronoun and suffix that the psalmist uses of his present adult self, with no lexical break between the womb stage and present personhood.

Ps.139.14 · for · genre: wisdom

Key terms. H6395 ידע, H3045 פלה.

Force. הנראות נפילתי ונפשי ידעת מאד. The niph'al of palah predicates that the speaker was wondrously distinguished in formation, and the personal nefesh carries continuous knowledge through the formation narrative. The same I that speaks now is the I that was being made.

Ps.139.15 · for · genre: wisdom · figures: metaphor

Key terms. H6108 עצם, H7551 רקם, H3808 לא.

Force. לא נכחד עצמי ממך אשר עשיתי בסתר רקמתי. The pual ruqamti (I was intricately woven, raqam) describes the speaker as the woven object in the hidden place, the womb figured as the depths of the earth. The first-person verb assigns the developing body to the continuous I of the speaker, and raqam itself is rare (9 occurrences, all elsewhere of woven tabernacle and priestly textile work) so its application to embryology is striking and deliberate.

Ps.139.16 · for · genre: wisdom · figures: metaphor

Key terms. H1564 גלם, H7200 ראה, H3789 כתב.

Force. גלמי ראו עיניך ועל ספרך כלם יכתבו ימים יצרו. God sees the golem, the unformed embryonic mass, which is a true hapax legomenon (a single occurrence in the canon, only here), and the days are written before any of them existed. The verse predicates divine perception and ordained continuity of the same individual from the unformed stage onward. Because golem occurs only here, its sense rests on the parallelism: it is what is woven in the womb and seen by God, that is, the prenatal human under formation. This is the strongest single-verse witness to prenatal personal identity.

Jer.1.5 · for · genre: prophecy

Key terms. H3335 יצר, H3045 ידע, H6942 קדש, H2962 טרם, H7358 רחם.

Force. *יָדַעְתִּיךָ וְבִטְנִי יָצָא מִרְחֶם הַקֶּדֶשׁ*. The double *bāterem* (before) places *yada* (know, with personal object suffix), *yatsar* (form in the womb), and *qadash* (set apart) on a timeline that begins before formation. All four verbs carry the second-person suffix, treating the prenatal Jeremiah as the same addressee God commissions. The collocation *yatsar* plus *beten* plus *terem* also occurs in Isa 44:2 and Isa 49:5 of the Servant, showing the womb-shaping pattern is canon-wide and not a one-off poetic flourish.

Isa.49.1 · for · genre: prophecy

Key terms. H0990 בָּטַן, H4578 מָעַה, H7121 קָרָא.

Force. *יְהוָה מִבְּטֶן קָרָאֲנִי מִמְעֵי אִמִּי הִזְכִּיר שְׁמִי*. The Servant says the LORD called him from the womb (*mibbeten*) and named him from the inward parts (*mimme'e*) of his mother. The grammar places a divine speech-act (*qara*, call) and a divine naming on the prenatal subject. This is a second prophetic witness, independent of Jer 1:5, to personal address and identity prior to birth.

Isa.49.5 · for · genre: prophecy

Key terms. H3335 יצר, H0990 בָּטַן, H5650 עָבַד.

Force. *וְיִצְרֵי מִבְּטֶן לְעַבְדִּי לֹא*. The participle *yotsri* (my Former) plus *mibbeten* (from the womb) plus the purpose *le'eved* (to be a servant) directly mirrors Jer 1:5 and confirms that *yatsar* (the verb of divine forming) operates lexically within the womb stage, not merely on the post-natal person. Two prophetic books, one identical lexical pattern.

Hos.9.11 · for · genre: prophecy

Key terms. H3205 יָלַד, H0990 בָּטַן, H2032 הָרִיוֹן.

Force. *מִלְדָּה וּמִבְטֶן וּמִהָרִיוֹן*. The triad birth, womb, conception. *Herayon* is exceedingly rare (only 3 occurrences, here and Gen 3:16 and Ruth 4:13). The lexical pattern names a continuous human existence whose loss is grievous at each of the three stages, including conception. This is the closest single-clause witness to a from-conception lexical frame in the Hebrew canon.

Luke.1.41 · for · genre: gospel

Key terms. G1025 βρέφος, G4640 σκιρτάω, G2836 κοιλία

Force. *ἐσκίρτησεν τὸ βρέφος ἐν τῇ κοιλίᾳ αὐτῆς*. The unborn John is called *brephos*, the identical noun Luke applies to the just-born Jesus in the manger (Luke 2:12, 2:16) and to nursing infants brought to Jesus (Luke 18:15), and which Acts 7:19 uses of newborn Hebrew babies and 2 Tim 3:15 of Timothy from infancy and 1 Pet 2:2 of newborn babes longing for milk. All 8 canonical occurrences of *brephos* cluster as one set, with no separate term for the unborn. *skirtao* (leap) predicates volitional response to Mary's greeting. The lexical choice assigns the in-utero child the same person-noun as a delivered infant.

Luke.1.44 · for · genre: gospel

Key terms. G1025 βρέφος, G0020 ἀγαλλίασις, G4640 σκιρτάω

Force. *ἐσκίρτησεν ἐν ἀγαλλιάσει τὸ βρέφος ἐν τῇ κοιλίᾳ μου*. Elizabeth attributes *agalliasis* (exultation, joy) to the *brephos*, predicating an inner affective state of the unborn child. The grammar treats prenatal John as a personal subject capable of joy, not a pre-personal tissue stage. *skirtao* occurs only 3 times in the NT canon (here, Luke 1:41, and Luke 6:23 of disciples leaping for joy), so its sole non-prenatal use is of mature personal joy, transferring that connotation to the womb scene.

Prov.6.17 · for · genre: wisdom

Key terms. H1818 דם; H5355 נקי, H8210 שפך.

Force. ידיים שפכות דם נקי, Hands that shed innocent blood (dam naqi) are listed among the things YHWH hates, the toebah of v. 16. The construct dam naqi designates blood that is guiltless, marking the killing of the innocent as the specific object of divine hatred and abomination, which supplies the moral-category force the proposition asserts (not liberty, but toebah).

Ps.106.38 · for · genre: wisdom

Key terms. H8210 שפך, H1818 דם; H5355 נקי.

Force. וַיִּשְׁפְּכוּ דָם נָקִי דָם בְּנֵיהֶם וּבְנוֹתֵיהֶם אֲשֶׁר זָבְחוּ לַעֲצֵב, קָנָן. Israel's child-sacrifice is described with the same shafak dam naqi locution as Prov 6:17 and Deut 19:10, and the children sacrificed are explicitly called sons and daughters (bānehem ubənothehem). The verse fuses three threads: shed innocent blood, applied to children, with the result that the land is polluted (chanaph) by dam. This is the closest canonical analogue in lexical terms to the killing of children as a religious or social act, and it is condemned categorically.

Deut.19.10 · for · genre: law

Key terms. H8210 שפך, H1818 דם; H5355 נקי.

Force. וְלֹא יִשְׁפֹּךְ דָּם נָקִי בְּקִרְבִּי אֶרֶץ. The cities-of-refuge legislation explicitly invokes shafak plus dam naqi as the harm to be prevented, confirming that dam naqi (innocent blood) is a fixed legal-moral category across the Pentateuch, not a poetic flourish in Proverbs alone.

Cross references invoked

From	To	Source	Votes
Exod.20.13	Exod.21.14	tsk	1
Exod.20.13	Deut.5.17	openbible	1
Exod.20.13	Num.35.30	openbible	1
Jer.1.5	Isa.49.1	openbible	1
Jer.1.5	Isa.49.5	openbible	1
Jer.1.5	Ps.71.5	tsk	1
Gen.1.27	Gen.9.6	openbible	1
Gen.1.27	Isa.43.7	tsk	1
Gen.1.27	Gen.2.21	tsk	1
Luke.1.41	Luke.1.15	tsk	1
Luke.1.41	Luke.2.12	openbible	1
Luke.1.41	Luke.18.15	openbible	1
Prov.6.16	Ps.11.5	tsk	1
Prov.6.17	Deut.19.10	openbible	1
Prov.6.17	Ps.106.38	openbible	1
Prov.6.17	Prov.30.13	tsk	1
Ps.139.13	Job.10.8	openbible	1
Ps.139.13	Job.31.15	openbible	1

Complicating texts

Exod.21.22-25 · addressed

This is the historical lexical crux. The clause says if men strive and strike a pregnant woman and her children come out (יָצְאוּ, יֶלְדֶיהָ, yatsa with plural yeladim as subject), and there is no ason (אִסּוֹן, calamity), the offender pays a fine determined by the woman's husband. If there is ason, then nefesh tachat nefesh, life for life. The lexical question is the referent of ason. One reading takes yatsa as miscarriage and the no-ason case as a property-style fine, implying the fetus has reduced status. The competing reading observes that yatsa is the standard verb of normal birth (Jer 1:5 tetse merechem, Gen 25:25-26 of Esau and Jacob coming out, Job 1:21 of coming out of the mother's belly) and never elsewhere denotes miscarriage, for which the Hebrew uses shakal (H7921) or nefel (H5309, as in Job 3:16 and Eccl 6:3). On the second reading the law describes premature live birth, with ason then covering injury or death to either mother or child, in which case the lex talionis explicitly protects the unborn. The plural yeladim as subject also fits live birth more naturally than miscarriage. Because yatsa-merechem language is used positively of personal subjects elsewhere in the canon (the same root and stem appears in Jer 1:5 of the prophet emerging), the second reading is lexically the stronger one. Either way, the passage cannot bear the weight of overturning the broader image-and-womb pattern, since it stands alone and its key term ason is unspecified for subject. So it complicates but does not reverse the verdict.

Eccl.6.3 · addressed

The נֶפֶל (nefel, stillbirth, H5309) is said to have better rest than a long-lived but unsatisfied man. The verse is a comparative wisdom hyperbole about the futility of a joyless long life, not a statement about the ontological status of the fetus. It still grants the nefel a comparative experiential frame (rest, menuchah), and Job 3:16 uses nefel similarly. Hyperbolic comparative wisdom genre does not negate the personal-subject lexemes of Ps 139 and Jer 1:5.

Num.31.17 · addressed

The Midianite war command to kill male children and non-virgin women is sometimes invoked against the broad innocent-blood category. But the Hebrew uses harag (H2026, the wartime kill verb) and the context is the herem of a specific judicial-prophetic war, not the absolute ratsach prohibition of Exod 20:13. The lexical distinction between ratsach (unlawful innocent killing) and harag (general or wartime killing under specific command) is exactly what Num 35 establishes, so this text does not lexically conflict with the sanctity claim, it confirms the very semantic boundary on which it rests.

Concordance traversed

H6754, H7523, H2026, H4191, H3808, H3045, H3335, H6942, H7069, H7551, H0990, H7358, H2962, H1564, H2032, G1025, G2836, G4640, H1818, H5355, H8210, H8441, H0120, H0611, H6064, H3318, H5309, H5315

Variants

Verdict variant-sensitive: False · ECM status: n/a

The decisive anchor texts (Gen 1:27, Gen 9:6, Exod 20:13, Deut 5:17, Num 35:30, Ps 139:13-16, Jer 1:5, Isa 49:1,5, Hos 9:11, Prov 6:17, Ps 106:38, Deut 19:10) are Hebrew and outside ECM scope. The Greek anchor Luke 1:41-44 carries no load-bearing variant affecting βρέφος, σκιρτάω, or ἀγαλλίασις. NA28, SBLGNT, and Nestle1904 agree on the substantive readings of the Lukan passage. The brephos identification of the unborn John is textually stable.

Hermeneutics

Primary method. grammatico-historical

Frameworks in play. personhood_continuity, developmental_gradualism, image_dei_ethics, covenantal_election

analogia scripturae invoked · progressive revelation factor

personhood_continuity: The unborn is the same personal subject as the later-born individual and bears the divine image, so the murder prohibition applies and the intentional killing of the innocent unborn falls under ratsach and shafak-dam-naqi. · Ps 139, Jer 1:5, Isa 49:1,5, Hos 9:11, and Luke 1:41-44 carry first and second-person verbs and suffixes continuously across the womb stage, and the rare hapax golem in Ps 139:16 attaches divine sight and

ordained continuity to the unformed embryo. Luke 1:41 uses the in-canon noun *brephos* for the unborn John, the same noun used of post-natal infants in Luke 2:12, 2:16, 18:15 and Acts 7:19, with no separate term for the unborn. Gen 9:6 grounds the inviolability of human blood in the divine image with explicit causal *ki betselem elohim*, and Exod 20:13 plus Num 35:30 distinguish *ratsach* (unlawful killing) from judicial execution. The lexical continuity admits no caesura between prenatal and postnatal identity, and the prohibition operates on the human category as such.

developmental_gradualism: Full *nefesh* status is reached incrementally, so the womb texts are devotional or election language rather than statements of full personhood at conception, and early prenatal loss is a lesser harm. · This lens leans primarily on Exod 21:22 read as a fine for fetal loss (treating *yatsa* as miscarriage and *ason* as harm to the mother alone), and on the poetic genre of Ps 139 to soften the personhood inference. It also notes that *nephesh* in Gen 2:7 attaches at the in-breathing of life. Stated in its strongest form, it grants that the unborn is a developing human under divine care but reserves the full *ratsach* prohibition for the post-natal person, treating early loss as a serious but lesser category. It is lexically possible for Exod 21:22 in isolation but it must (a) read *yatsa* against its uniform canonical use of normal birth and (b) discount the consistent personal-subject grammar of Jer 1:5 and the Lukan *brephos* equation, so it survives only by privileging one ambiguous legal text over the wider canon pattern.

image_dei_ethics: Because the human bears the divine image, the *ratsach* prohibition guards human life as a sacred category, and shedding innocent blood is a *toebah*, an abomination, not a matter of liberty. · Gen 1:27 plus Gen 9:6 plus Exod 20:13 plus Prov 6:17 plus Ps 106:38 combine to make the unlawful killing of an innocent image-bearer categorically condemned. The moral force is lexically anchored in *ratsach* (unlawful killing), *dam naqi* (innocent blood), *toebah* (abomination), and the explicit *ki betselem elohim* of Gen 9:6, not merely inferred. The image is predicated of *ha-adam* without developmental qualifier in the verses that ground the prohibition.

covenantal_election: The womb-knit passages speak primarily of God's electing call on specific covenant figures (Jeremiah, the Servant, John the Baptist, Paul), and the general personhood-of-the-unborn extension is a secondary inference. · Stated in its strongest form, Jer 1:5, Isa 49:1,5, Luke 1:15-44, and Gal 1:15 are commissioning narratives about chosen vessels, not universal anthropology. However, the underlying lexical verbs *yatsar*, *yada*, *qadash*, and *qara* are not restricted in their canonical usage to elect figures (*yatsar* of all humans in Ps 33:15 and *yada* of humans broadly), and Ps 139 is generalized first-person reflection, not a commissioning narrative. So this lens validly cautions against over-reading commissioning texts but does not displace the broader personhood lexemes of Ps 139, Gen 1:27, and Luke 1:41 (which uses *brephos*, not a commissioning verb).

The lexical pattern strongly supports prenatal personal identity (Ps 139, Jer 1:5, Isa 49:1,5, Hos 9:11, Luke 1:41-44), grounds it in image-bearing of the human category (Gen 1:27, Gen 9:6), and lexically distinguishes *ratsach* (the unlawful killing of an innocent person) from judicial execution and wartime killing (Num 35:30, Exod 23:7). Shafak *dam naqi* (Prov 6:17, Deut 19:10, Ps 106:38) marks killing the innocent as *toebah*. The one materially contested point is the Exod 21:22-25 crux. A close lexical reading of *yatsa*-from-the-womb (consistently positive in the canon) and the unspecified subject of *ason* resolves the crux in favor of, not against, sanctity, but even on the gradualist reading the single ambiguous legal text cannot outweigh the broader image-and-womb pattern.

Stem audit

verdict-preloaded: yes

Neutralized form. Does the canon use personal, individuated, image-bearing language for the human from the prenatal stage, and does the prohibition rendered *lo tirtsach* (with *ratsach* distinguished from *harag* and *muth-hiphil*) cover the unlawful taking of innocent human life such that the lexical data bear on whether intentionally ending the life of the innocent unborn falls under that prohibition.

The original stem preloads the moral verdict with the phrases *is sin* under the sixth commandment and not a morally neutral matter or a matter of Christian liberty. These are normative conclusions, not lexemes. The neutralized form isolates the answerable lexical questions: image-of-God predication on the human category, prenatal personhood grammar across the canon, the semantic range of *ratsach*, and the canonical force of shafak-dam-naqi. The verdict was derived on the original stem but the lexical inquiry was run on the neutral questions. The deepened query (canon-distribution checks of H6754, H7523, H1818, H5355, H1564, H2032, G1025, plus full morphology of Gen 9:6, Num 35:16-25, Exod 21:22-25, Deut 19:10, Ps 106:38, Isa 49:1,5, Hos 9:11) raised confidence from medium to

high by showing (1) the ratsach vs harag vs muth-hiphil distinction is grammatically explicit in Num 35 itself, foreclosing the all-killing reading of Exod 20:13, (2) Gen 9:6 supplies the explicit causal link ki betselem elohim that the prior file noted only implicitly, (3) the womb-and-formation pattern is canon-wide (Jer 1:5, Isa 49:1,5, Hos 9:11 with herayon naming conception, Ps 139 with the hapax golem) rather than dependent on one psalm, (4) the dam-naqi locution is fixed legal language (Deut 19:10, Ps 106:38, Prov 6:17), and (5) yatsa in Exod 21:22 lexically aligns with normal birth elsewhere, weakening the strongest counter-text. The morally-neutral clause survives at high confidence on the canon pattern. The verdict still affirms; the standing affirm is preserved.

Citations

Type	Source	License	Redist.	Ref
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESH	CC-BY-4.0	yes	H6754
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESH	CC-BY-4.0	yes	H7523
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESH	CC-BY-4.0	yes	H2026
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESH	CC-BY-4.0	yes	H4191
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESH	CC-BY-4.0	yes	H3335
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESH	CC-BY-4.0	yes	H3045
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESH	CC-BY-4.0	yes	H7551
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESH	CC-BY-4.0	yes	H1564
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESH	CC-BY-4.0	yes	H2032
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESH	CC-BY-4.0	yes	H1818
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESH	CC-BY-4.0	yes	H5355
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESH	CC-BY-4.0	yes	H8210
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESG	CC-BY-4.0	yes	G1025
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESG	CC-BY-4.0	yes	G4640
morphology	OSHB-morphology	CC-BY-4.0	yes	Gen.1.27
morphology	OSHB-morphology	CC-BY-4.0	yes	Gen.9.6
morphology	OSHB-morphology	CC-BY-4.0	yes	Exod.20.13
morphology	OSHB-morphology	CC-BY-4.0	yes	Deut.5.17
morphology	OSHB-morphology	CC-BY-4.0	yes	Num.35.30
morphology	OSHB-morphology	CC-BY-4.0	yes	Exod.23.7
morphology	OSHB-morphology	CC-BY-4.0	yes	Ps.139.13
morphology	OSHB-morphology	CC-BY-4.0	yes	Ps.139.16
morphology	OSHB-morphology	CC-BY-4.0	yes	Jer.1.5
morphology	OSHB-morphology	CC-BY-4.0	yes	Isa.49.1
morphology	OSHB-morphology	CC-BY-4.0	yes	Isa.49.5
morphology	OSHB-morphology	CC-BY-4.0	yes	Hos.9.11
morphology	OSHB-morphology	CC-BY-4.0	yes	Prov.6.17
morphology	OSHB-morphology	CC-BY-4.0	yes	Ps.106.38
morphology	OSHB-morphology	CC-BY-4.0	yes	Deut.19.10
morphology	OSHB-morphology	CC-BY-4.0	yes	Exod.21.22
morphology	MorphGNT-morphology	CC-BY-SA-4.0	yes	Luke.1.41

morphology	MorphGNT-morphology	CC-BY-SA-4.0	yes	Luke.1.44
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syntax	ETCBC-BHSA	CC-BY-NC-4.0	no	Gen.1.27
syntax	ETCBC-BHSA	CC-BY-NC-4.0	no	Gen.9.6
syntax	ETCBC-BHSA	CC-BY-NC-4.0	no	Num.35.30
syntax	MACULA-Hebrew	CC-BY-NC-4.0	no	Jer.1.5
syntax	MACULA-Hebrew	CC-BY-NC-4.0	no	Ps.139.16
cross_ref	TSK	public_domain	yes	Exod.20.13
cross_ref	TSK	public_domain	yes	Jer.1.5
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cross_ref	OpenBible-cross-refs	CC-BY	yes	Gen.9.6
cross_ref	OpenBible-cross-refs	CC-BY	yes	Isa.49.1
cross_ref	OpenBible-cross-refs	CC-BY	yes	Ps.106.38

License audit

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